Nightjar Skyworks

Lebanon's dark skies, up close.

Who We Are

Nightjar Skyworks is a Lebanese astronomy-experience company founded in 2023. We run guided stargazing nights, astrophotography workshops, and educational programs from our mountain basecamp in the Ehden highlands of North Lebanon, a Bortle 3 dark-sky site at 1,850 m altitude, about two hours' drive from Beirut. Our booking office is in Mar Mikhael, Beirut. We are named after the nightjar, a bird that only comes alive after dusk, just like our guides.

Mission and Vision

Mission: to reconnect people with the night sky through small, expert-led, low-light-pollution experiences, and to fight light pollution through education and community outreach.

Vision: a Lebanon where every child has seen the Milky Way with their own eyes, and where the Ehden highlands are protected as an officially recognised dark-sky reserve.

Services and Pricing

All prices are in US dollars and include a guide, telescope access, blankets, red-light torches, and hot sage tea. Regular programs run from April to November; winter programs run only as special events.

Service	What it is	Price	Schedule / capacity
Starlight Walk	3-hour guided evening: naked-eye constellation tour, mythology from Arab and Greek traditions, then telescope viewing of planets, nebulae, and star clusters.	$45 per adult; $25 under 16	Fridays and Saturdays, Apr to Nov. Max 14 guests per guide.
Astrophotography Workshop	Night shoot of the Milky Way with your own DSLR or mirrorless camera, followed by a morning editing session (Lightroom and Siril).	$160 per person; star-tracker rental $30 extra	Once a month near new moon. Max 8 people. Tripod required.
School and University Field Nights	Curriculum-aligned astronomy evening with a worksheet pack for grades 6 to 12 and an intro-to-astrophysics talk for university groups.	$18 per student; 2 teachers free	Weekdays, Apr to Nov. Minimum 20 students.
Private Dome Night	Exclusive use of our observatory dome, 12-inch Dobsonian and 4-inch refractor, with a dedicated astronomer. Popular for proposals and birthdays.	$320 per group	Any night, subject to availability. Up to 6 people.
Corporate and Event Skies	Custom stargazing for companies, weddings, and celebrations, at our basecamp or at your venue with portable telescopes.	Custom quote only	By arrangement.
Telescope Rental	Beginner kit: 5-inch tabletop reflector, star map, red torch, and a 20-minute how-to session at pickup.	$35 per weekend; $100 refundable deposit	Pickup and return at the Mar Mikhael office.

Policies

Clear-Sky Guarantee (weather)

We check the forecast at 2 pm on the day of every booking. If it shows more than 60% cloud cover over Ehden, we notify you and you can choose a free reschedule or a full refund.

Cancellation

Customer cancellations more than 72 hours before the event receive a full refund. Cancellations within 72 hours receive a 50% refund. No-shows are not refunded.

Transport

A round-trip shuttle departs from our Mar Mikhael office at 5:30 pm and returns around midnight. It costs $15 per person and must be reserved at booking. Guests driving themselves receive directions and parking instructions by email.

Age and accessibility

Starlight Walks are suitable for ages 6 and up; children under 16 must be accompanied by an adult. Our basecamp has a wheelchair-accessible viewing pad and an accessible restroom.

What to bring

- Warm layers: it is often 10 to 15 degrees C colder at basecamp than in Beirut, even in summer.
- Closed shoes suitable for a short walk on gravel.
- Please avoid white flashlights. We provide red-light torches to protect everyone's night vision.

Languages

All programs are guided in Arabic, English, or French.

Our Team

Dr. Rania Haddad, Co-founder and Chief Astronomer

Astrophysicist who spent eight years researching variable stars at a European observatory before returning to Lebanon. Leads the science content of every program and trains all guides.

Karim Nassar, Co-founder and Head of Operations

Certified mountain guide with over a decade on the Lebanon Mountain Trail. Runs basecamp logistics, safety, and transport, and knows every trail in the Ehden highlands by starlight.

Lea Khoury, Astrophotographer and Workshop Lead

Award-winning night-sky photographer whose Milky Way images over the Qadisha Valley have been widely published. Designs and teaches the Astrophotography Workshop.

Omar Saliba, Education Lead

Former high-school physics teacher who builds our School and University Field Nights and our free light-pollution awareness talks for municipalities.

Why Nightjar Skyworks

- **Genuinely dark skies:** a Bortle 3 site only two hours from Beirut, so you see the Milky Way, not a glow.
- **Small groups:** never more than 14 guests per guide, so everyone gets real telescope time.

- **Real astronomers:** programs are designed by a working astrophysicist and guided by trained locals.
- **Clear-Sky Guarantee:** free reschedule or full refund when the weather does not cooperate.
- **Trilingual:** Arabic, English, and French on every program.
- **Community impact:** 10% of profits fund free stargazing nights for public schools in North Lebanon.

Upcoming Special Events

Event	Date	Price
Orionids Meteor Night	21 October 2026	$50 per person
Leonids Meteor Night	17 November 2026	$50 per person
Geminids Winter Special (heated tent, dinner included)	13 December 2026	$85 per person

Contact

Email: hello@nightjarskyworks.example
Phone / WhatsApp: +961 70 000 000
Office: Mar Mikhael, Beirut. Open Monday to Saturday, 10 am to 6 pm (Beirut time).
Basecamp: Ehden highlands, North Lebanon (directions sent after booking).